



CODE OF CONDUCT

Policy Owner	Human Resources Department
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Approved By	Circle Business Head
Applies To	All employees of MZOBS

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of the Policy

This Code of Conduct sets out the standards of behaviour, ethics and professionalism that MZOBS expects from every member of its workforce. It exists to give employees a clear understanding of what is expected of them, to protect the dignity and wellbeing of all who work with us, and to safeguard the reputation and long-term success of the Company.

The Code is not intended to cover every situation that may arise. Where a situation is not addressed, employees are expected to apply good judgment, act with integrity and seek guidance from their manager or the Human Resources (HR) Department.

1.2 Scope and Applicability

This Code applies to all directors, officers, permanent, probationary, fixed-term, part-time and temporary employees, interns, trainees, and consultants or contractors engaged by MZOBS, regardless of position or seniority.

- It applies at all Company premises, client sites, Company-sponsored events and business travel.
- It applies to work-related activities conducted remotely, online or outside normal working hours.
- It applies to conduct outside the workplace where that conduct affects the Company's reputation, its employees or its business interests.

1.3 Statement of Commitment to Ethical Conduct

MZOBS is committed to conducting its business with honesty, fairness and integrity. We hold ourselves to the highest ethical standards in our dealings with employees, clients, suppliers, regulators and the communities in which we operate.

Management leads by example and is responsible for creating a culture in which ethical behaviour is expected, recognized and supported, and in which concerns can be raised without fear of retaliation. Every employee is responsible for reading, understanding and complying with this Code.

2. General Conduct

2.1 Professionalism and Ethical Behaviour

Employees are expected to act professionally and ethically at all times.

- Perform duties diligently, competently and to the best of their ability.
- Be honest and transparent in all business dealings and in all records and reports.
- Treat colleagues, clients, vendors and visitors with courtesy and respect.
- Maintain punctuality and regular attendance, and follow approved leave procedures.
- Maintain a professional standard of dress and personal presentation appropriate to the role.
- Take responsibility for mistakes, and report them promptly rather than conceal them.

2.2 Compliance with Laws and Regulations

Employees must comply with all laws, regulations and statutory requirements applicable to the Company's business and to their role, including labor, tax, anti-corruption, data protection and industry-specific regulations. Where Company policy sets a higher standard than the law, the higher standard applies. Any employee who is unsure of the legal requirements affecting their work must seek guidance before proceeding.

- Bribery, kickbacks, facilitation payments and any form of corruption are strictly prohibited.
- Gifts or hospitality must be modest, infrequent and never offered or accepted to influence a business decision. Gifts above a nominal value must be declared to HR.
- Employees must cooperate fully with lawful audits, inspections and investigations.

2.3 Conflict of Interest

A conflict of interest arises when personal interests, relationships or outside activities interfere, or appear to interfere, with an employee's duty to act in the best interests of the Company. Employees must avoid such conflicts and disclose any potential conflict promptly and in writing to their manager and HR.

- Holding a financial interest in a competitor, supplier or client, other than minor holdings in publicly listed companies.
- Undertaking outside employment, consulting or business activity without prior written approval.
- Using one's position to secure employment, contracts or favours for family members or close associates.
- Participating in a hiring, promotion or procurement decision involving a relative or close personal relationship.

2.4 Use of Company Resources

Company resources, including equipment, vehicles, software, funds, supplies, facilities and working time, are provided for legitimate business purposes. Limited and reasonable personal use of certain resources (such as telephone or internet) is tolerated provided it does not interfere with work, incur significant cost, or breach any Company policy or law.

- Expense claims must be accurate, supported by receipts and consistent with the Company's travel and expense policy.
- Company funds and property must never be used for personal gain or for unlawful purposes.
- Employees must not use Company time to conduct personal business or outside work.

2.5 Protection of Company Assets

Every employee is responsible for protecting the Company's physical, financial, intellectual and digital assets against loss, theft, damage, misuse and waste.

- Secure laptops, mobile devices, access cards and keys at all times, and report loss or theft immediately.
- Do not remove Company property from the premises without authorization.
- Report any suspected fraud, theft or misappropriation to HR or through the reporting channels in Section 7.
- Return all Company property, records and access credentials upon separation from the Company.

3. Workplace Relationships

3.1 Respectful and Inclusive Behaviour

MZOBS values diversity and is committed to an inclusive workplace in which every individual is treated with dignity and respect. Employees are expected to listen to others, value differing perspectives, collaborate constructively and refrain from language or conduct that is demeaning, offensive or exclusionary.

3.2 Non-Discrimination and Equal Opportunity

The Company provides equal employment opportunity to all employees and applicants. Decisions on recruitment, compensation, training, promotion, transfer, discipline and termination are based solely on merit, qualifications, performance and business needs. Discrimination on the basis of any of the following is prohibited:

- Race, colour, caste, ethnicity, national or social origin
- Religion or belief
- Sex, gender, gender identity or expression, sexual orientation
- Marital or family status, pregnancy or maternity
- Age
- Disability or medical condition
- Any other characteristic protected by applicable law

3.3 Harassment and Bullying Prevention

MZOBS maintains a zero-tolerance approach to harassment, bullying, intimidation, victimization and violence in any form, whether committed in person, in writing, by telephone or through digital channels. Prohibited conduct includes, but is not limited to:

- **Sexual harassment:** unwelcome advances, requests for sexual favours, sexually suggestive comments, gestures, images or physical contact, and any conduct creating an intimidating, hostile or offensive environment. The Company complies with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, and has constituted an Internal Committee to receive and address complaints.
- **Bullying:** repeated behaviour that humiliates, threatens, isolates or undermines an individual, including abuse of authority, public ridicule and malicious rumours.
- **Retaliation:** any adverse action against a person who reports harassment or participates in an investigation.

3.4 Privacy and Confidentiality

The Company respects the privacy of its employees. Personal information collected by HR is used only for legitimate employment and legal purposes, is stored securely and is accessible only to authorized personnel. Employees must respect the privacy of colleagues and must not access, discuss or disclose another person's personal, medical, payroll or disciplinary information without proper authorization.

4. Communication and Technology Usage

4.1 Respectful and Effective Communication

Communication at MZOBS should be clear, timely, honest and courteous. Employees are expected to communicate constructively, address disagreements professionally and escalate issues through the appropriate channels rather than through gossip or public criticism.

4.2 Proper Use of Company Communication Channels

Company email, messaging platforms, telephones and video-conferencing tools are provided for business use and remain Company property.

- Use only Company-approved platforms for business communication and document sharing.
- Do not use personal email or unapproved messaging or storage applications to transmit Company or client information.
- Official statements to the media, investors or regulators may be made only by authorized spokespersons.

4.3 Email and Internet Usage Guidelines

Employees should have no expectation of privacy in their use of Company systems. To the extent permitted by law, the Company may monitor and review system activity for security, compliance and legitimate business purposes.

- Write emails professionally; avoid offensive, defamatory, discriminatory or misleading content.
- Do not open suspicious attachments or links, and report phishing attempts to IT immediately.
- Do not access, download or distribute pornographic, hateful, illegal or otherwise inappropriate material.
- Do not install unlicensed or unauthorized software, or use Company systems to infringe copyright.
- Protect passwords, use multi-factor authentication where provided, and never share credentials.

4.4 Social Media Guidelines

Employees are personally responsible for what they post online. When using social media, whether for personal or professional purposes, employees must:

- Not disclose confidential or proprietary information about the Company, its clients or colleagues.
- Make clear that personal views are their own and do not represent the Company, unless authorized to speak on its behalf.
- Not post content that harasses, discriminates against or defames any person or the Company.
- Not use the Company's logo or brand identity without approval from Management.
- Exercise caution when connecting with clients and colleagues, and maintain professional boundaries.

5. Confidentiality and Data Protection

5.1 Handling of Confidential Information

Confidential information includes business strategies, financial data, pricing, client and vendor details, employee records, trade secrets, source code, product plans and any non-public information entrusted to or generated by the Company. Employees must:

- Use confidential information solely for authorized business purposes.
- Share it only with those who have a legitimate need to know.
- Avoid discussing it in public places or in the presence of unauthorized persons.
- Continue to protect it after their employment with the Company ends.

5.2 Protection of Sensitive Data

MZ OBS is committed to protecting personal and sensitive data in accordance with applicable data protection laws, including the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, and the Information Technology Act, 2000, together with their associated rules.

- Collect, use and store personal data only for specified, lawful purposes.
- Apply appropriate safeguards, such as encryption, access controls and secure disposal.
- Report any actual or suspected data breach to the IT and HR Departments immediately, and no later than 24 hours after discovery.
- Do not copy or transfer sensitive data to personal devices or unauthorized storage.

5.3 Intellectual Property Rights

All work product, inventions, designs, software, documents, processes and other intellectual property created by employees in the course of their employment, or using Company resources, is the exclusive property of MZ OBS, subject to applicable law and the terms of individual employment agreements. Employees must respect the intellectual property rights of third parties and must not copy, use or distribute copyrighted or licensed material without permission.

6. Health, Safety, and Environmental Responsibility

6.1 Commitment to a Safe and Healthy Workplace

MZ OBS is committed to providing a safe, healthy and secure working environment. The Company will comply with applicable health and safety legislation, provide appropriate training and equipment, and take reasonable steps to prevent accidents, injuries and work-related illness. The Company also recognizes the importance of employee wellbeing and encourages a healthy work-life balance.

6.2 Employee Responsibilities for Maintaining Safety

Every employee shares responsibility for safety and must:

- Follow all safety rules, procedures, signage and instructions.
- Report accidents, injuries, near-misses, unsafe conditions and hazards immediately.
- Participate in fire drills, emergency evacuations and safety training.
- Not work under the influence of alcohol, illegal drugs or any substance that impairs judgment or performance.
- Not bring weapons, explosives or hazardous materials onto Company premises.
- Not engage in threats, violence or horseplay that endangers others.

6.3 Sustainable Practices and Reducing Environmental Impact

MZ OBS seeks to minimize its environmental footprint and to operate sustainably. Employees are encouraged to:

- Conserve energy and water, and switch off lights and equipment when not in use.
- Reduce, reuse and recycle materials, and minimize paper use by preferring digital documents.
- Dispose of waste responsibly, including electronic waste, in line with Company procedures.
- Choose sustainable travel options where practical.
- Suggest ideas for improving the Company's environmental performance.

7. Compliance and Reporting

7.1 Compliance with Laws, Regulations, and Policies

Compliance is a condition of employment. Employees must comply with this Code, all other Company policies and procedures, and all applicable laws. Managers are responsible for ensuring that their teams understand these requirements and for modeling compliant behavior. Ignorance of the Code is not an acceptable defense for a violation.

7.2 Reporting Violations or Concerns

Employees who witness or suspect a violation of this Code, Company policy or the law have a duty to report it promptly and in good faith. Concerns may be raised through any of the following channels:

- Their immediate supervisor or department head
- The Human Resources Department (hr@mzobs.com)
- The Internal Committee (for matters of sexual harassment)
- The confidential Ethics Hotline: [phone number / email to be inserted]

7.3 Whistleblower Protection

MZ OBS strictly prohibits retaliation against any person who reports a concern in good faith or who assists in an investigation. Retaliation, including dismissal, demotion, harassment, transfer or threats, is itself a serious violation of this Code and will result in disciplinary action. Reports may be made anonymously, and the identity of the reporter will be kept confidential to the fullest extent possible, consistent with the need to investigate and any legal obligations. Knowingly making a false or malicious report is also a violation of this Code.

8. Consequences of Violations

8.1 Disciplinary Actions for Code of Conduct Violations

Violations of this Code will be addressed fairly and consistently. The action taken will depend on the nature, severity, frequency and impact of the violation, and on the employee's prior record. Disciplinary measures may include, singly or in combination:

- Verbal counselling or caution
- Written warning
- Final written warning
- Suspension with or without pay, subject to applicable law
- Withholding of increment, bonus or promotion
- Demotion or transfer
- Termination of employment
- Referral to law enforcement or regulators, and recovery of losses, where appropriate.

8.2 Procedures for Investigation and Resolution

All reports of misconduct will be taken seriously and handled in accordance with the principles of natural justice.

- **Step 1 – Receipt:** The complaint is logged by HR and acknowledged within 3 working days.
- **Step 2 – Assessment:** HR conducts a preliminary review to determine whether a formal investigation is required and to put interim safeguards in place if needed.
- **Step 3 – Investigation:** An impartial investigator or committee gathers evidence and interviews the complainant, the respondent and witnesses. The respondent is informed of the allegations and given a fair opportunity to respond.
- **Step 4 – Findings:** A written report is submitted to the appropriate management authority, normally within 30 days of commencement.
- **Step 5 – Decision:** Management, in consultation with HR, decides on the outcome and any disciplinary or corrective action.
- **Step 6 – Appeal:** The employee may appeal in writing to the Managing Director within 7 days of the decision. The appeal decision is final.
- **Step 7 – Closure:** The outcome is communicated to the parties concerned, records are retained confidentially, and any systemic lessons are addressed.

9. Policy Review and Updates

9.1 Regular Review and Updates

The HR Department is responsible for reviewing this Code at least once every year, and sooner where required by changes in law, regulation, business operations or best practice. Proposed amendments will be reviewed by senior management and approved by the Managing Director or Board before taking effect. Version history will be maintained by HR.

9.2 Communication of Policy Changes to Employees

Any revision to this Code will be communicated to all employees by email and through the Company intranet, with a summary of key changes. New joiners will receive this Code as part of their induction and must sign an acknowledgment. Employees will be required to re-affirm their compliance following material updates, and periodic training will be provided to reinforce understanding of the Code.

Employee Acknowledgment

I, the undersigned, acknowledge that I have received, read and understood the MZOBs Code of Conduct. I agree to comply with its provisions and understand that any violation may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment. I also understand that I am responsible for asking questions and reporting concerns whenever I am uncertain or aware of a potential violation.

Employee Name: _____

Employee ID / Designation: _____

Department: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Issued by:

Aseem Mishra

(Circle Business Head)